Spirit Trail Fiberworks

Flower Petals Lace Shrug

Designed by Shelia January

For Spirit Trail Fiberworks

Soft and luxurious cashgora ~ merino yarn knits into a stunning shrug with a beautiful halo in openwork lace. Worked from the center out, this vest-type shrug has arm openings, and the circular shape allows the lace edging to form a soft shawl collar. The edging is done in garter lace so that it is reversible and looks the same on the body and the collar of the shrug.

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Dimensions (one size fits all) - 42-44" in diameter, depending on how tightly it is knit.

Materials: 800 yards Spirit Trail Fibers "Isis" Cashgora ~ Merino Yarn

Gauge: 17 stitches / 4 inches measured over stockinette stitch swatch

Needles and Tools:
8 US (5.5mm) circular needle at least 26* in length
8 US (5.5mm) set of double pointed needles
Stitch markers
Tapestry needle
Decorative Button

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Chart Legend

•	Knit
b	Knit through the back loop
/	Knit 2 together
⌿	Knit 2 together with the next body stitch on the left needle
\	SSK (slip, slip, knit 2 slipped stitches together)
⤡	SSK with next body stitch, yarn to back between SSK's
⅄	Centered double decrease (SL 2, K 1, P2SSO)
○	Yarn over
■	No stitch (placeholder on chart only)
→	Slip stitch to the end of previous section, replacing marker

Method-

Using the double pointed needles, cast on 8 stitches and join in a circle. It is helpful to use a cast-on method that can be tightened, such as casting on over a slip knot, which will eliminate a hole when the garment is finished.

The Body Chart shows one of the 8 sections of the circle. It is very helpful to use stitch markers between the sections, and a differently colored marker for the beginning of the round.

Begin working Body Chart, noting that the Body Chart only shows the odd rows. All even rows are knitted. You may want to copy the chart and enlarge it.

After the cast on, knit one round even, without any increases (Row 1 of chart). In Row 2 there will be an increase before each of the eight stitches, and stitch markers will be placed between every two stitches (16 stitches).

Important Note – the petals of the center floral motif are formed on the **sides** of each section as Rows 7 through 23 are worked. On Rows 21 and 23, you will be moving stitches from the beginning of each section to the end of the previous section in order to work the decreases that form the petals, in other words, you'll be moving the stitch markers so that the final double decrease in each section is incorporating stitches from the two adjoining sections. Please read the chart legend and chart carefully at this point so that the petals form.

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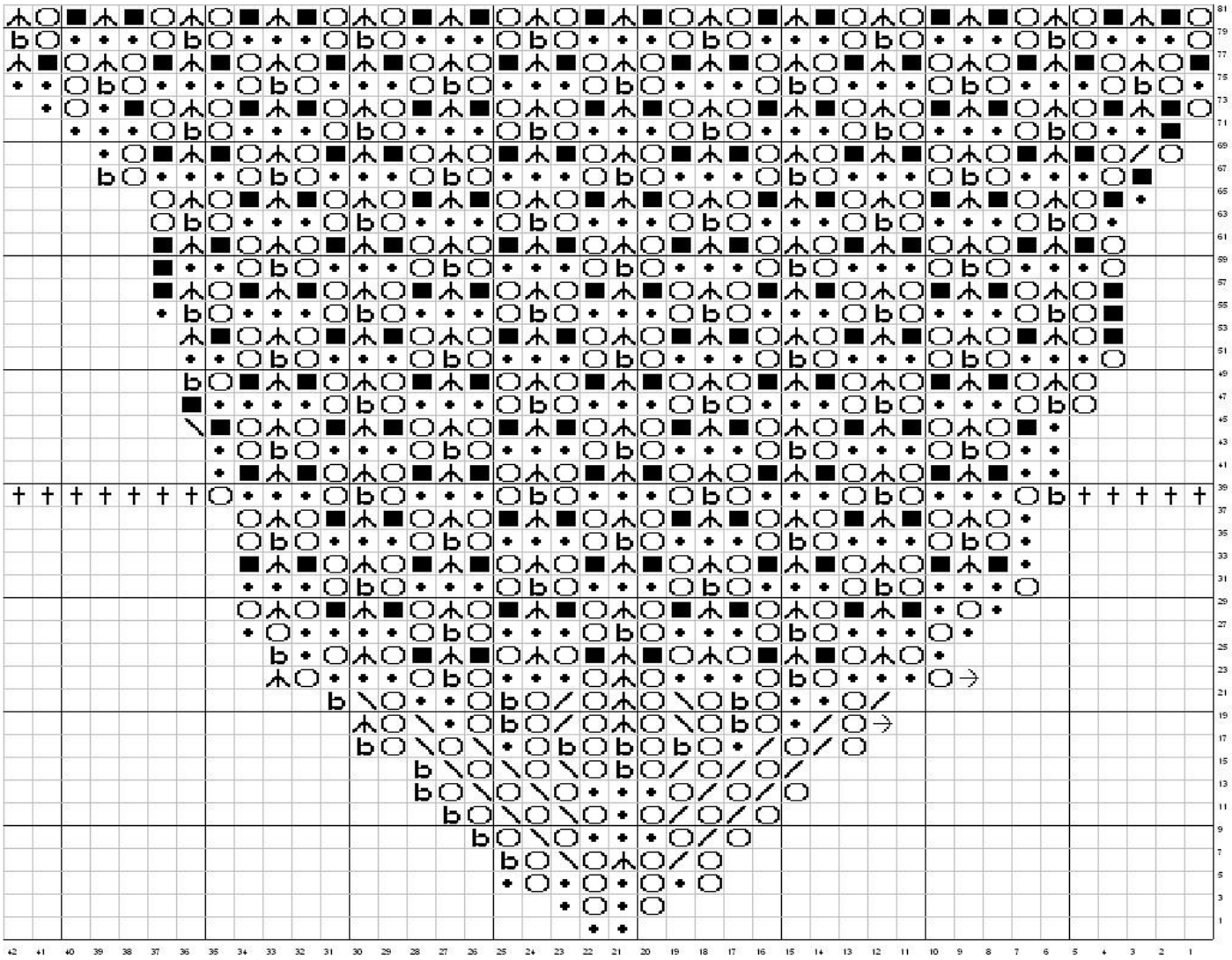
Body Chart



The + symbols on Row 39 indicate that this is the row after which the arm openings are worked. The arm openings will be worked on Sections 3 and 8. When the diameter is large enough, switch to 16” circular needle, and then to the 26” needle as the circumference increases even further and it is comfortable to do so.

Row 40 - Work all stitches in knit on Sections 1 and 2, as this is an even row. When the 3rd section is reached, bind off all stitches in the section. Work Sections 4, 5, 6, and 7 in knit, then bind off all stitches in Section 8.

Row 41 - Work as per Body Chart. When Sections 3 and 8 are reached, cast on 30 stitches. In succeeding rows, these sections will be worked according to the chart.

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In order to have continuity in the shape of the chart, “no stitch” symbols sometimes appear at the beginning and ends of the rows. The symbol still means no stitch in this position.

The stitch count in each row fluctuates dramatically once the work has progresses past Row 21. Because of the “no stitch” symbols, this is not readily apparent when looking at the chart. To assist in checking the stitch count as the shrug is worked, the ending number of stitches in each section, by row, is listed below. (Don’t worry about the changes in stitch count, this is what creates the openness of the stitch pattern, it will be a flat fabric).

Row 1	2 stitches
Row 3	4 stitches
Row 5	8 stitches
Row 7	8 stitches
Row 9	10 stitches
Row 11	12 stitches
Row 13	14 stitches
Row 15	14 stitches
Row 17	18 stitches
Row 19	18 stitches
Row 21	20 stitches
Row 23	24 stitches
Row 25	18 stitches
Row 27	26 stitches
Row 29	19 stitches
Row 31	28 stitches
Row 33	18 stitches
Row 35	28 stitches
Row 37	20 stitches
Row 39	30 stitches
Row 41	20 stitches
Row 43	30 stitches
Row 45	21 stitches
Row 47	31 stitches
Row 49	22 stitches
Row 51	33 stitches
Row 53	22 stitches
Row 55	33 stitches
Row 57	22 stitches
Row 59	33 stitches
Row 61	22 stitches
Row 63	34 stitches
Row 65	24 stitches
Row 67	36 stitches
Row 69	26 stitches
Row 71	38 stitches
Row 73	28 stitches
Row 75	42 stitches

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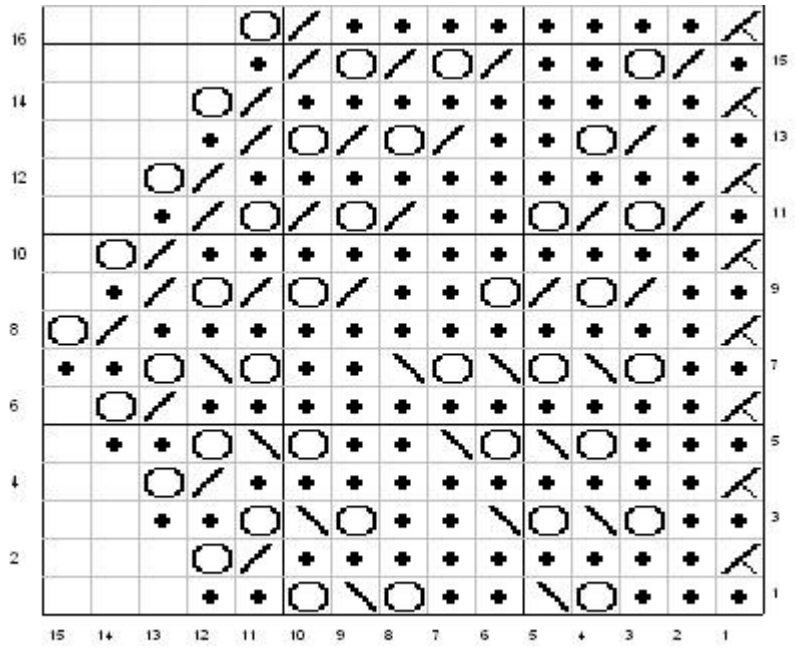
Row 77	28 stitches
Row 79	42 stitches
Row 81	28 stitches

When Row 82 (which is even, so will be knitted on all stitches) is completed, the edging will be knitted on. Break the yarn, and cast 11 stitches onto one of the double pointed needles. The edging will be worked on two double pointed needles and attached clockwise around the shrug body using K2TOG on the even numbered rows of the edging chart. The last stitches of the even numbered rows of the edge chart will be worked with the next stitch from the body, as indicated on the right side of the chart. This results in one end of the circular needle used on the body sitting idly while the other is used with the double pointed needles. It may be helpful, especially in the first few inches of the edging, to put a point protector on the unused needle point.

The Edging Chart is knitted lace, which means that there are yarn overs on both sides of the work. In this case, there is only one yarn over on the even-row side. The chart below shows both odd and even rows. **Note** – the edging is attached to the live stitches of the body every other row – this means that each 16-row repeat will "use up" 8 live stitches from the shrug body.

Edging Chart



When all of the body stitches have been used, the edging chart will have been knit 28 times. You have a choice at this point - the edging can be bound off and the bound-off edge sewn to the edging cast-on edge, or the 11 live edging stitches can be grafted to the 11 edging cast-on stitches. Both will work well.

Using either a single crochet stitch or a crocheted crab stitch (working from left to right), work a firm row around each of the armhole openings. This will tighten up the armholes and help to prevent sagging during wearing.

Block the shrug, pinning the arm holes so that there is approximately 2 ½ inches between the two edges. The shrug itself will be blocked into a circle. Weave in all ends, tightening in the center to eliminate the cast-on opening. Trying on the shrug, note the best position for a fastener. A button can be sewn to the left side edge of the shrug, and it will button through the lace openings on the edging. A shawl pin could be an alternative to the button. The shrug can also be worn upside down if a shorter length and larger "collar" appeals to you.

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Shelia January knits, spins, sews, weaves, and makes lots of jams and jellies on her farm in the Pacific Northwest. She has been knitting since she was 8 years old, but still loves playing with yarn and fiber. With a highly organized stash, Shelia knows just where to go to put her hands on whichever yarn is calling to her. You can visit Shelia and see what's on the needles, or spinning wheel, at http://letstalkstash.blogspot.com.